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Bazaar

Apple iPhone 6S Plus

Offers best in class performance at an insurmountable premium

In terms of looks and design, the iPhone 6S Plus is almost exactly similar to last year's 6 Plus. It has a new sturdier aerospace grade aluminium alloy to not only safeguard against last year's bendgate fiasco but also to up the reliability game several notches in light of new embellishments (re: 3D Touch). As far as design and looks go, the 6S Plus radiates understated elegance, capturing a minimalist yet premium look. It feels nice and chunky to hold, unlike some of the razor thin, size-zero phones out there.

However, given Apple's own unforgiving design standards, we absolutely hate the camera bump on the rear panel. Also, it's time for Apple to incorporate a (software or hardware) back button anchored to the bottom-bezel as larger-screened iPhones (like this one) flounder with single-handed use.

A much touted feature of both the 6S and 6S Plus – 3D Touch – is a bit of a hit and miss in its current state, and no we aren't doubting Apple's product engineering skills or its ability to drum up 3D Touch-supported apps within the ecosystem. Apart from Mail (which truly wows you with Peek and Pop), Camera app and a couple of supported games, there's hardly any useful software-side implementation of 3D Touch that fundamentally changes the way in which you interact with the screen. Apple's Taptic Engine works well in tandem with the 6S Plus' cover glass, which Apple claims to be the sturdiest in the industry, distinctly letting you realize the difference between a soft (Peek) or hard (Pop) press. What's more, 3D Touch's sensitivity can be customized to your tastes as well. If you're an iPhone 6 or 6 Plus user wondering if life sucks without 3D Touch, don't fret overmuch. You're good till iPhone 7.

In terms of performance, the iPhone 6S Plus blows past the competition. While compared to the Samsung Galaxy Note 5 – the overall best performing Android smartphone at the moment – the iPhone 6S Plus offers more than double in terms of graphics performance. It also offers very good single-core and multi-core results, delivering best in class mobile gaming experience and multitasking capabilities that are right up there among the best.



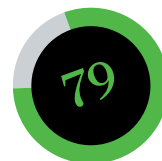
Price
₹92,000
(128GB model)

The new 12MP iSight camera is exceptionally good at taking true-to-source still images and videos in sunlight, artificial and low light scenarios – both indoors and outdoors. Optical image-stabilization works like a charm especially while shooting videos (4K and timelapse), smoothing most shakes and jolts extremely well. Both in videos (HD and 4K) and photos, whether its front or rear camera, the iPhone 6S Plus consistently captures close to natural colour of subjects and portrays nearly accurate amount of light in each scene – unlike any of its current competitors. If you're a gaming aficionado, the 6S Plus offers the best graphics performance for mobile gaming right now. One of the reasons why everything you see on an iPhone's screen feels just right or true-to-source in terms of colours is thanks largely to the 6S Plus' screen calibration, an underappreciated fact that more than makes up for its lack of an AMOLED panel.

While extra battery life is a perennial want, the iPhone 6S Plus continues to impress – we managed to eke out 15 hours of battery life from the 6S Plus (at 25% screen brightness) with constant 3G connection, Apple Watch paired on Bluetooth, with moderate social media and music. Onboard sound is delightfully loud on the iPhone 6S Plus, comparable to the output of some laptops we've tested recently, which is quite an achievement. Although not as ubiquitous as Google Now, Siri is vastly improved with some new tricks, adding to her general allure. Lastly, Apple's iOS 9 beats at the heart of the 6S Plus, stitching together a seamless experience that you need to see to believe. This unique marriage of hardware and software gives Apple the edge against its competitors.

All things considered, the iPhone 6S Plus is a great premium smartphone with best-in-class performance. iPhone 6, 6 Plus users don't really need the update, but for everyone else, the question posed in front of you is this: Are you willing to spend between ₹64k to ₹92k for this luxury device? We just can't wrap our heads around this reality distortion field. If you can, great, definitely go for it.

Jayesh Shinde



Features	81
Performance	91
Design	91
Value	51

Specifications

Display: 5.5-inch, Full HD IPS LED-backlit, with 3D Touch; **CPU:** Dual-core A9 chip with M9 motion coprocessor; **RAM:** 2GB LPDDR4; **GPU:** A9 GPU; **Camera:** 12MP (rear) with OIS & 4K video, 5MP (front); **OS:** iOS 9; **Wireless:** Wi-Fi 802.11ac, Bluetooth 4.2, NFC; **Storage:** 128GB (also available in 16GB & 64GB models); **Colours:** Silver, Gold, Space Gray, Rose Gold; **Weight:** 192g; **Connectors:** 3.5mm, Lightning to USB cable, power adapter; **Earphones:** Yes, Apple EarPods

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